Case study · Domenico Perroni

PAYROLL OPERATIONS

Catching payroll errors before the client does

Client: An Italian payroll provider sending payslips for six clients and 182 employees under four collective agreements (retail and services, engineering industry, bars and restaurants, logistics), with errors planted on purpose.

> **Which payslips are wrong before they go out, by how much, and what does the November 2026 pay increase cost each client?**

67 of 67
planted errors found, with no false alarms

10
employees below their agreement's minimum: €305.24 a month plus arrears

€212.40
less withholding tax in one F24 than the payslips add up to

€2,448.98
a month to pay in November 2026, after absorption

WHAT I DID

- Wrote twenty-two checks that recompute each item from the client's agreement, INPS and the 2026 tax law, not from the payroll software: minimums, seniority steps, each client's INPS rate, sick and maternity pay with the employer's top-up, income tax and the adjustment at leaving, leave hours, TFR at leaving, holidays, 13th and 14th month, notice.
- Read each agreement's rules in the texts its signatories publish or filed at CNEL, and kept them in one table: steps, monthly payments, part months, holidays, notice, sick pay and top-up.
- Reconciled the F24 tax payment with the sum of each client's payslips.
- Delivered the checks three ways that agree: Python, a live-formula sheet for Google Sheets and a browser tool in English and Italian.

WHAT IT FOUND

- Five contributions withheld at the wrong rate: CIGS and the FIS share missing above 15 staff on average, CIGS taken below it, the extra 1% forgotten above €4,685 a month.
- Leavers carry errors in the 14th month, holiday, notice and severance: a coefficient from the wrong month, the 17% substitute tax not deducted.
- Most errors in the new clients are another agreement's rule applied by mistake: steps every three years where they are every two, INPS sick pay advanced to an industrial white-collar employee, 50% where bars and restaurants get 80%, a top-up at retail's 75% in logistics.
- Each flag comes with the expected value, the value found and what to do.

WITH REAL DATA

- A pilot on one client's real payslips, run in the browser so the files never leave the office.
- Blue-collar staff and drivers, whose sick pay base and notice follow other rules.
- A monthly record of what the checks caught, to measure the errors avoided.

How it is checked. The sheet checked against Python on 1,682 values; the browser tool on 3,909 values, half-cent alterations and Italian file formats included; every rule with its source in the agreement, an INPS circular or ISTAT's indices.

Italian payroll · Four CCNLs · Process controls · Google Sheets · Python

Try the tool https://d0m3n1c0x.github.io/controlli-cedolini/strumento/?lang=en

Read the report (Italian) https://d0m3n1c0x.github.io/controlli-cedolini/

The repository https://github.com/D0M3N1C0X/controlli-cedolini

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